

Improving End-of-Life Care for Chinese Canadians

A UBC Faculty member in Social Work is applying for grant funding to do a qualitative study focusing on how to improve physician communication with Chinese Canadians (CC) and their relatives when their patients were receiving end-of-life care.

Summary:

This qualitative study will be conducted to expand knowledge about CC experiences and opinions about end-of-life care. Multiple-meeting focus groups will be held to build trust and allow time for full participation. Following a review, protocols would be approved by the University's Clinical REB (CREB). Participants will be CC adults who had experienced at least one death of a significant other or family member. Convenience sampling by staff will be used to recruit participants, and flyers will be distributed at neighborhood activities. Participants will be screened for eligibility and assigned to one of two focus groups. Focus group 1 will be comprised of CC's with family members who had died at home. Focus group 2 will include CC's with family members who had died in the hospital.

Data collection:

All participants will be asked for an informed consent. An open-ended interview script will stimulate discussion about (1) positive and negative experiences of participants related to end-of-life care in the hospital or at home, (2) preferences for treatment by health care providers, (3) communication issues, and (4) end-of-life decision making pertaining to living wills and advance directives. An CC member of the project staff will moderate the focus groups.

Each session will be audio-taped. Unlabeled tapes will be mailed to a transcriptionist in their labeled plastic cases. The transcriptionist will transcribe the tapes and the transcripts will be sent back to the project team for identification of which focus group and which session should be used to identify each transcript. Focus Group Participants' comments will be identified on the transcript by either Miss, Mrs. or Mr. plus the first initials of their first name and last name. The transcripts will be also reviewed for accuracy by the project team.

Data analysis:

Transcripts will be reviewed for themes through a continuous process of text data segment comparison based on qualitative research techniques. After reading the transcripts several times, a codebook will be developed defining themes and subthemes, and a numeric theme code was assigned to each particular category of text responses. Microsoft Word will be used to create transcript tables of participant responses which then could be sorted by theme code. Participants' responses will be coded and sorted accordingly into differing categories which will then summarized to capture the richness and range of data within each theme code. The analysis will be systematic and involve triangulation of data from the two focus group sources.

Data Retention:

The tapes will be eventually destroyed and the transcripts and other files generated during the analysis will remain with the PI who will serve as a data steward.